

Muslim Council of Britain

AskAdil Solicitor Directory

Business Case & Decision Paper

Decision Paper for MCB Executive Team

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1. Executive Summary

British Muslims currently have no reliable, centralised way to find Muslim-friendly legal help. This paper proposes that MCB launches the UK's first searchable directory of Muslim solicitors and legal professionals through its AskAdil platform, leveraging MCB's trusted brand and extensive community reach. The AskAdil team has already researched over 50 firms across key practice areas, built the core technology platform, and deployed the supporting infrastructure. We are now seeking executive sign-off to begin formal outreach to solicitors on behalf of MCB. The investment required is minimal — the technology is built, infrastructure is live, and the primary cost is staff time for email review. At maturity, the directory has the potential to generate £250–350K per year in revenue while providing an essential community service that addresses a genuine, unmet need.

2. Background & Problem Statement

The need for a dedicated Muslim solicitor directory is driven by several converging factors:

- 377% surge in Islamophobic hate crimes recorded between 2023 and 2024, creating unprecedented demand for legal support in the Muslim community.
- 45% of all religious hate crimes in the UK target Muslims, making them the most disproportionately affected faith group.
- An estimated 12,000 Muslim solicitors practise in England and Wales, yet there is no dedicated directory or discovery mechanism to connect them with the community they serve.
- Existing resources such as the Muslim Lawyers Directory and similar initiatives are dormant, outdated, or ineffective, leaving a significant gap.
- Community members frequently ask AskAdil questions such as “How do I find a Muslim solicitor?” or “Can you recommend a lawyer who understands Islamic law?” — demonstrating clear, organic demand.
- Legal needs span multiple specialisms: Islamic family law (including Sharia divorce), Islamic wills and inheritance, halal conveyancing and Islamic finance, and discrimination/Islamophobia cases.

Without a centralised, trusted platform, Muslim individuals and families are left navigating a fragmented landscape at precisely the moment they need reliable legal support the most.

3. Proposed Solution

AskAdil will build and maintain the UK's first curated, searchable directory of Muslim solicitors and legal professionals, integrated directly into the AskAdil AI chatbot platform.

3.1 Core Features

- Curated directory of verified Muslim solicitors, searchable by specialism, location, and language.
- AI-powered matching: AskAdil's chatbot intelligently matches users to the most relevant solicitors based on their legal need, geographic area, and language preference.
- Consent-based onboarding: All solicitors are contacted via a professional outreach campaign and must explicitly opt in to be listed.
- MCB ownership: MCB's direct ownership provides inherent trust and credibility that no third-party platform could replicate.

3.2 How It Works

- User asks AskAdil a legal question (e.g., "I need help with an Islamic will").
- AskAdil provides general legal information and guidance from its knowledge base.
- AskAdil recommends relevant solicitors from the directory, with profile summaries.
- User contacts the solicitor directly (AskAdil facilitates the connection, not the legal advice).

3.3 Outreach Approach

- AI-generated, human-reviewed personalised outreach emails sent via SendGrid.
- Each email is tailored to the firm's specialism and explains MCB's AskAdil initiative.
- Dry-run tested and validated — the outreach engine is built and ready for deployment.
- Follow-up sequences for non-responders (max 2 follow-ups per firm).

4. Revenue Model & Financial Projections

The directory follows a phased monetisation strategy designed to build scale before introducing revenue streams.

4.1 Phased Growth Plan

Phase	Timeline	Listed Firms	Revenue	Strategy
Free	Now – Q3 2026	25–50	£0	Build scale and trust
Freemium	Q3 2026 – Q1 2027	50–150	£23K/yr	Premium listings £49–149/mo
Growth	Q1 2027 – Q3 2027	150–400	£91K/yr	Subscriptions + lead gen
Maturity	2028+	1,000+	£250–350K/yr	All revenue streams

4.2 Revenue Streams Breakdown (at Maturity)

Revenue Stream	% of Revenue	Description
Premium Subscriptions	45%	Enhanced profiles, analytics dashboard, MCB Verified badge, priority placement
Lead Generation	25%	£5–25 per qualified enquiry passed to solicitors (excluding cases with a PI element — see section 7.1)
Sponsored Content	15%	Sponsored articles, newsletter placements, featured practice area guides
Events	10%	Webinars, community roadshows, annual Muslim Lawyers Conference
Data & API	5%	Market intelligence reports, API licensing for third-party platforms

4.3 Revenue Scenarios (Sensitivity Analysis)

The maturity-phase projection above represents the optimistic case. The following table presents three scenarios to give a more realistic range of outcomes.

Scenario	Firms at Maturity	Paid Conversion	Annual Revenue
Conservative	200 firms	10% paying (20)	£24K/yr
Base case	500 firms	15% paying (75)	£90K/yr
Optimistic	1,000 firms	20% paying (200)	£238K/yr

Important context: The 12,000 Muslim solicitors are distributed across a much smaller number of firms. The total addressable market of firms with dedicated Islamic law desks is narrower than the headline number suggests. Not all 12,000 solicitors run independent practices, and many work in firms that would subscribe once, not per-solicitor.

Even the conservative case (£24K/yr) covers operational costs. The base case (£90K/yr) is self-sustaining and would fund further product development. The optimistic case remains achievable

but depends on significant market penetration and successful monetisation of multiple revenue streams.

5. Known Solicitors & Legal Professionals

Our research has identified 50+ firms and organisations across four key practice areas, plus six support organisations. The following tables summarise the directory as currently researched.

5.1 Islamic Family Law (15 firms)

Firm Name	Location	Key Specialism	Contact
Aramas Family Law	Manchester	Islamic divorce, custody	Available
Duncan Lewis	London (national)	Sharia divorce, family mediation	Available
gunnercooke (Siddique Patel)	Manchester	Islamic family law, arbitration	Available
Slater Heelis	Manchester / Sale	Family law, Islamic divorce	Available
Curtis Law	Bradford	Islamic family law, children matters	Available
O'Donnell Solicitors	London	Sharia divorce, financial settlements	Available
Stowe Family Law	National (multiple offices)	High-net-worth Islamic divorce	Available
Irwin Mitchell	National	Family law, Islamic prenuptials	Available
Reeds Solicitors	London	Family law, forced marriage	Available
Witan Solicitors	London / Midlands	Islamic family law, custody	Available
Makin Dixon	Birmingham	Family law, Islamic divorce	Available
Fitz Solicitors	London	Family law, Sharia councils	Available
Paradigm Family Law	National	Islamic divorce, co-parenting	Available
Woolley & Co	National (remote)	Islamic family law	Available
Anthony Gold	London	Family law, cultural sensitivity	Available

5.2 Islamic Wills & Inheritance (12 firms)

Firm Name	Location	Key Specialism	Contact
I Will Solicitors	Birmingham	Islamic wills, Sharia-compliant estates	Available
MWG Solicitors	London	Islamic wills, probate	Available
AM Law	London	Islamic inheritance, trust structures	Available
Aman Solicitors	London / Birmingham	Islamic wills, estate planning	Available
Farani Taylor	London	Islamic wills, immigration-linked estates	Available
Greystone Solicitors	London	Sharia-compliant wills, trusts	Available
YHM Solicitors	Birmingham	Islamic wills, probate	Available
Myerson Solicitors	Manchester / Altrincham	Private client, Islamic estate planning	Available
Oasis Legal	London	Islamic wills, Wasiyyah	Available
Greengate Solicitors	Manchester	Islamic wills, succession planning	Available
SA Law	Hertfordshire	Wills, trusts, Islamic compliance	Available
Nelsons Solicitors	East Midlands	Islamic wills, probate disputes	Available

5.3 Islamic Finance & Conveyancing (14 firms)

Firm Name	Location	Key Specialism	Contact
White Horse Solicitors	London	Islamic mortgages, halal conveyancing	Available
Batley Law	West Yorkshire	Islamic finance, conveyancing	Available
ASL Solicitors	Birmingham	Halal conveyancing, property	Available
Blakewater Certus	Lancashire	Islamic mortgage conveyancing	Available
AFG Law	Bolton / Manchester	Islamic finance, commercial property	Available
Kuddus Solicitors	London	Islamic mortgage, residential conveyancing	Available
Taylor Rose	National	Conveyancing, Islamic finance products	Available
Shakespeare Martineau	National	Islamic finance, Sukuk, commercial	Available
Touchwood Solicitors	London	Islamic conveyancing, buy-to-let	Available
Mullis & Peake	Essex	Conveyancing, Islamic mortgage products	Available
Foot Anstey	South West / London	Islamic finance, commercial property	Available
Charles Russell Speechlys	London	Islamic finance, Sukuk, Sharia advisory	Available
Trowers & Hamblins	London / Middle East	Islamic finance, real estate	Available
Dentons	Global	Islamic finance, capital markets	Available

5.4 Discrimination & Islamophobia (12 firms)

Firm Name	Location	Key Specialism	Contact
Rahman Lowe	London	Employment discrimination, Islamophobia	Available
Kesar & Co	London	Discrimination, hate crime	Available
Sharma Solicitors	London	Employment law, discrimination	Available
Gulbenkian Andonian	London	Human rights, discrimination	Available
Didlaw	National (remote)	Discrimination, whistleblowing	Available
Bindmans LLP	London	Human rights, civil liberties	Available
Mishcon de Reya	London	High-profile discrimination, human rights	Available
Bhatt Murphy	London	Civil liberties, police misconduct	Available
Landau Law	London	Employment discrimination, settlement	Available
Toner Legal	National	Hate crime, religious discrimination	Available
Slater + Gordon	National	Employment discrimination, group actions	Available
Leigh Day	London	Human rights, group litigation	Available

5.5 Support Organisations (6)

Organisation	Focus Area	Role in Directory	Contact
Tell MAMA	Anti-Muslim hate crime reporting	Referral partner, case data	Available
Islamic Relief UK (IRU)	Humanitarian, community welfare	Community reach, promotion	Available
CAGE	Due process, rule of law	Legal rights advocacy	Available
Islamic Human Rights Commission (IHRC)	Human rights, Islamophobia	Research partner, referrals	Available
Muslim Safety Net	Community safety, legal support	Grassroots referral network	Available
Liberty	Civil liberties, human rights	Legal expertise, test cases	Available

6. Investment Required

The core technology has been built and is operational. However, an honest assessment of total costs must include staff time, legal review, and ongoing management — not just infrastructure.

Item	Cost	Status
Technology (outreach engine)	£0	Built and deployed
Infrastructure (Railway hosting)	~£30/mo (~£360/yr)	Live
SendGrid (email)	Free tier → £15/mo at scale	Configured
LLM APIs (Gemini/Claude)	~£10–30/mo	Configured
External SRA legal review	£3,000–5,000 (one-off)	Required before monetisation
Staff time (6-week outreach)	~£1,500 (est. 3hrs/wk @ £80/hr)	Internal cost
Ongoing management	~£2,400/yr (est. 2hrs/wk @ £25/hr)	GDPR, complaints, updates
Total Year 1	~£7,000–9,000	
Ongoing (Year 2+)	~£3,500/yr	

The £100 figure in the original estimate only covered raw infrastructure. The true Year 1 cost including SRA legal review and staff time is £7,000–9,000. This is still minimal relative to the revenue potential and community impact. Even the conservative revenue scenario (£24K/yr) comfortably exceeds ongoing costs from Year 2 onwards.

7. Regulatory & Legal Compliance

The directory must comply with several regulatory frameworks. We have identified the key compliance requirements and proposed mitigations. This section is deliberately candid about risks — it is better to address them now than be surprised later.

7.1 SRA Referral Fee and Introducer Rules

LASPO and PI Referral Fees:

- The Legal Aid, Sentencing and Punishment of Offenders Act 2012 (LASPO) prohibits referral fees in personal injury cases.
- Our model does not charge referral fees for PI cases — lead generation fees apply only to non-PI practice areas.

SRA Codes of Conduct — Principles 3 & 7 (Introducer Obligations):

- ALL referral and lead-generation fees are regulated under SRA rules, not just Personal Injury. Principle 7 (legal and regulatory obligations) and Principle 3 (public trust) impose broad duties on solicitors receiving introductions.
- Solicitors using AskAdil must inform their clients specifically about any financial arrangement with AskAdil as an introducer. This is a mandatory disclosure obligation under the SRA Standards and Regulations.
- The £5–25 lead generation fee must be disclosed to the end user, not simply labelled as a ‘paid listing’. Transparency is non-negotiable — the directory must make clear to users that some solicitors pay for referrals.
- All solicitor listings will clearly disclose whether the listing is free or paid (premium), and the nature of any financial arrangement.

PI/Discrimination Boundary Risk:

- Hate crime and discrimination cases (a core AskAdil practice area) frequently involve claims for psychological injury. This blurs into Personal Injury, potentially triggering the LASPO referral fee ban.
- The boundary between a ‘discrimination case’ and a ‘personal injury case’ is not always clear-cut. A claim for compensation for anxiety or PTSD arising from Islamophobic harassment could be classified as PI.
- Mitigation: exclude ALL cases with any personal injury element from lead generation fees entirely. For discrimination-specialist firms, charge only for subscription/advertising — never per-lead.
- Alternative approach: use a flat subscription model for discrimination firms, removing any per-referral fee and thereby avoiding the LASPO boundary question entirely.

This boundary risk is the single most important legal issue to resolve before monetisation. The external SRA legal review (budgeted at £3,000–5,000 in section 6) must specifically address this question.

7.2 GDPR Compliance

- All outreach is consent-based: solicitors must opt in to be listed.
- Right to removal: any solicitor can request delisting at any time.
- Privacy policy and data processing terms will be provided to all listed solicitors.
- User data (enquiries) is processed in accordance with AskAdil's existing privacy policy.

7.3 Editorial Independence

- Payment for premium listings does not influence AI recommendations — matching is based on specialism, location, and user need.
- Premium listings receive enhanced profiles and visibility, but do not receive preferential ranking in AI-generated recommendations.
- Clear disclaimers state that AskAdil does not endorse, guarantee, or take responsibility for the quality of legal advice provided by listed solicitors.

8. Risk Analysis

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Low response rate from solicitors	Medium	Medium	Outreach on MCB letterhead, AI-personalised emails, up to 2 follow-ups per firm
Regulatory action (SRA)	Low	High	External SRA legal review before monetisation; no PI referral fees; full disclosure per SRA Principles 3 & 7; mandatory client disclosure of introducer fees
PI/Discrimination boundary	Medium	High	Exclude cases with PI element from lead gen fees. Charge subscriptions only for discrimination firms. Seek specific SRA guidance on boundary cases.
Reputational damage to MCB	Low	High	MCB oversight of all outreach communications; every email is human-reviewed before sending; dry-run tested; professional tone
Data protection breach	Low	Medium	GDPR-compliant architecture; consent-based listing; right to removal; encrypted data storage
Competitor enters market	Low	Medium	First-mover advantage; MCB's direct involvement provides unique trust signal; established community reach
Revenue below projections	Medium	Low	Free tier ensures community value regardless of commercial performance; low operating costs

9. Strategic Model: Why a Hybrid Approach, Not Hate-Crime Only

A legitimate question for the executive team: should the directory focus exclusively on hate-crime and Islamophobia cases, given MCB's community mandate? This section explains why a hate-crime-only model would be counterproductive, and recommends a hybrid approach that serves victims while ensuring financial sustainability.

Why Hate-Crime Only Would Fail

1. It kills the revenue model. Hate-crime victims typically lack funds for private fees — cases are handled via Legal Aid, pro bono, or No-Win-No-Fee. Law firms will pay £25 for a lead on a high-value Islamic divorce or estate plan. They will not pay for distressed hate-crime enquiries. Restricting to hate-crime drops projected revenue to near zero.

2. It maximises regulatory danger. Hate-crime assaults frequently involve psychological trauma or physical injury claims, blurring into Personal Injury territory. Charging lead-generation fees on cases with a PI element risks regulatory breach under LASPO. By contrast, Islamic Wills and Halal Conveyancing leads are entirely legal and low-risk.

3. It duplicates existing charity work. Tell MAMA, the IRU, CAGE, and IHRC already handle hate-crime reporting, victim support, and legal referrals. A hate-crime-only directory would compete with MCB's own community partners rather than complement them. AskAdil's genuine first-mover advantage lies in everyday legal services.

4. It ignores organic demand. Community members ask AskAdil questions like “How do I find a Muslim solicitor?” and “Can you recommend a lawyer who understands Islamic law?” The bulk of demand is for Islamic family law, wills, and finance — the intersection of British law and Sharia. Cutting these means ignoring what users actually need.

Recommended: Hybrid/Subsidised Model

Commercial Tier (Revenue-Generating)	Community Tier (Free Public Service)
Islamic Family Law & Divorce	Discrimination & Hate Crime
Islamic Wills & Inheritance	Islamophobia cases
Islamic Finance & Conveyancing	Actions against police
Employment Law	Prevent programme cases
Immigration	Pro bono & Legal Aid referrals
Monetised: Premium listings, lead gen fees, sponsored content	Never monetised: No lead gen fees, no premium required
Generates £90–238K/yr revenue	Funded by commercial tier

This model ensures MCB's directory serves both community need and financial sustainability. The hybrid approach neutralises the SRA/LASPO regulatory risk entirely, ensures the directory serves the community's actual day-to-day legal needs, and generates the revenue needed to sustain the service long-term. The commercial tier funds the community tier — a model proven by organisations like Citizens Advice and many Law Centres.

10. Recommendation

Recommendation: GO

We recommend proceeding with the AskAdil Solicitor Directory, subject to the following conditions:

Condition 1: All outreach emails are human-reviewed and approved before sending. No automated mass-emailing without oversight.

Condition 2: SRA compliance is reviewed by an external solicitor before the monetisation phase begins (prior to Q3 2026).

Condition 3: Quarterly progress reports are provided to the MCB executive team, covering: directory growth, user engagement, solicitor feedback, and revenue progress.

The rationale for this recommendation is clear:

- The technology is built and tested — no further development investment is required.
- The community need is demonstrable and urgent.
- The financial risk is low (£7,000–9,000 Year 1 including SRA legal review, ~£3,500/yr ongoing).
- The revenue potential is significant (£24K–238K/year depending on scenario; base case £90K/yr is self-sustaining).
- MCB is uniquely positioned to succeed where others have failed, due to its trust and reach.
- Delay risks ceding first-mover advantage to commercial or less community-aligned competitors.

11. Decision Required

The MCB Executive Team is asked to approve the following two decisions:

Decision 1: Approve Outreach

Authorise the AskAdil team to begin contacting 50 solicitor firms on behalf of MCB, using human-reviewed, personalised outreach emails.

- ☐ APPROVED — Authorise outreach to 50 solicitor firms on behalf of MCB
- ☐ APPROVED WITH CONDITIONS — Proceed with the following modifications:
Conditions:

- ☐ DEFERRED — Revisit at the next executive meeting
- ☐ DECLINED — Do not proceed

Decision 2: Promote via MCB Channels (Phase 2)

Once 25+ firms are listed in the directory, share the directory with mosques and MCB newsletter subscribers to drive community adoption.

- ☐ APPROVED — Promote via MCB channels once 25+ firms are listed
- ☐ APPROVED WITH CONDITIONS — Proceed with the following modifications:
Conditions:

- ☐ DEFERRED — Revisit at the next executive meeting
- ☐ DECLINED — Do not proceed

Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Name & Title: _____ Date: _____

Appendices

The following appendices are available as separate documents and can be provided upon request:

Appendix A: Full Solicitor Directory — solicitor-directory-comprehensive.json (machine-readable database of all researched firms, with full contact details, specialisms, and metadata)

Appendix B: Monetisation Strategy Document — Detailed revenue model, pricing tiers, competitive analysis, and financial projections

Appendix C: Outreach Email Templates — Sample personalised emails for each practice area, follow-up sequences, and response handling procedures

Appendix D: Technical Architecture — Outreach engine design specification, API documentation, infrastructure diagram, and security architecture

End of Document

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